

DOJ skirts deadline on status of deportee

Agency says it needs more time; district judge now orders daily updates

BY STEVE THOMPSON, KATIE METTLER AND VICTORIA BISSET

The Trump administration refused to meet a federal judge's deadline Friday to share steps officials are taking to facilitate the return of a Maryland man mistakenly deported to a mega-prison in El Salvador, saying in a court hearing that the government needs more time to comply with a Supreme Court order.

A Justice Department lawyer told U.S. District Judge Paula Xinis at a hearing that the Trump administration was "still reviewing the Supreme Court's decision" regarding 29-year-old Kilmar Abrego García, a Maryland resident who was illegally deported to El Salvador last month.

The government's attorney, Drew C. Ensign, said he could not answer the judge's questions about Abrego García's whereabouts, including where the man is being held, what the government has done so far to secure his return and what it plans to do next.

"I'm asking a very simple question," Xinis said to Ensign. "Where is he?"

"I do not have that information," Ensign told the judge.

The standoff continued throughout the hearing as the government, which had already disregarded two court orders that day, refused to give clear answers to Xinis's questions — the kind of

SEE ORDER ON A4

At the border: Foreign visitors say crackdown doesn't faze them. A3

Deportation threat: Judge rules against Columbia grad student. A4



RAFAEL VILELA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Brazil's Príncipe da Beira Royal Fortress. Beyond lies a village populated by descendants of the enslaved Africans who built the fort.

As the storm approached, the men hacked deeper into the forest, searching for clues that might unravel a century-old mystery.

"We need to go 50 meters ahead," archaeologist Carlos Zimpel Neto said one morning in late January, looking down at his tablet, ignoring the booms of thunder. "Then a little to the left, then a little to the right."

He put down the tablet and, mosquitos in pursuit, plunged deeper into the grip of a remote jungle that had once yielded one of the Amazon's most remarkable archaeological discoveries: a vast Portuguese military fortress rising above the Guaporé River. The 1913 sighting of the fortress, which had been abandoned by Portugal and lost to the forest, begged a question that historians and archaeologists have struggled to answer

Scientists 'X-raying' the Amazon unlock lost human history

A colony around an 18th-century Portuguese fort had vanished. Then 'lidar' came along.

BY TERRENCE MCCOY IN COSTA MARQUES, BRAZIL

ever since.

Where was the rest?

Contemporaneous maps and historical records showed that the 18th-century Portuguese colony, which at its height sheltered at least 1,000 people, had extended far beyond the fortress. There was supposed to have been a city named Lamego. Military villas and churches. But the thick vegetation here along Brazil's border with Bolivia had concealed it all — until now.

Using a laser technology known as lidar, Zimpel and his team have rediscovered the lost Portuguese colony — finding an intricate urban system of canals, roads and military fortifications, and the remains of stone structures.

The breakthrough, announced in October, was the latest example of how lidar is ushering in a

SEE BRAZIL ON A10

Analysis contradicts IDF on Gaza medics' deaths

Israel cites self-defense. Video, audio offer a more disturbing narrative.

This article is by Miriam Berger, Louisa Loveluck, Imogen Piper, Hazem Balousha, Hajar Harb and Abbie Cheeseman

The 14 Palestinian emergency workers had been missing for a week when U.N. and civil defense personnel found them late last month in a mass grave of sand. Israeli soldiers had buried them, as well as the wreckage of their ambulances, videos showed. Their resting place, outside the southern Gaza city of Rafah, was marked with one of their red emergency lights.

The Israeli military says its soldiers had believed the men were Palestinian militants and had fired on them from a distance. Most of the vehicles were targeted, the military says, because they were deemed to be moving "suspiciously" in the direction of the troops. The burial of the bodies had adhered to protocol, the military said.

A Washington Post analysis of the events of that predawn morning, based on dispatcher records, witness testimony, video footage, satellite imagery and photographs

of the dead, contradicts the official Israeli narrative in key regards. While the Israeli military said the soldiers shot from afar, gunfire initially came from 150 feet away or less and, later, from about 50 feet away, according to the estimates of two audio forensics experts who analyzed video of the events at The Post's request.

While the Israel Defense Forces (IDF) said the initial vehicle its soldiers fired on was a "Hamas police" car carrying terrorists, dispatcher records secured by The Post and interviews indicate it was an ambulance that had been dispatched on an emergency call shortly before by the Palestine Red Crescent Society (PRCS) and carried a team of three paramedics who had 55 years of employment with the PRCS among them.

The five other vehicles that later came under fire were clearly marked as belonging to the PRCS and Palestinian civil defense. The paramedics who fled their vehicles were mostly wearing fluorescent clothes marking them as emergency workers, video shows. While the Israeli military initially told reporters that the soldiers fired on the vehicles because they did not have their flashing-red emergency lights on, video shows that they did.

In a statement Monday, the IDF said it was investigating the incident. "The preliminary inquiry in-

SEE RAFAH ON A9

A more combative Catholic

As he highlights his faith, Vance also exposes fissures within the church

BY PETER JAMISON



LEAH MILLIS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Vice President JD Vance with his daughter, Mirabel, and son Vivek during a visit to Notre Dame cathedral in Paris on Feb. 12.

Only three Catholics have won the presidency or vice presidency. For the first two, Democrats John F. Kennedy and Joe Biden, faith was a muted note in their public lives — a source of pride to millions of American Catholics but rarely invoked as a direct influence on policy.

The third, Vice President JD Vance, a Republican, has launched his current career as the nation's most prominent elected Catholic in a very different way. In less than three months, Vance has made a string of unusual forays into the fraught borderland between religion and politics, castigating the hierarchy of his own church and defending President Donald Trump's "America First" nationalism through appeals to ancient Christian texts.

Vance's pronouncements have divided his co-religionists and inflamed long-smoldering divisions within the church. In February, Pope Francis issued a remarkable letter to U.S. bishops that included a rebuke of Vance's public theologizing. But the vice president has equally staunch defenders among conservative American Catholics who have repeatedly criticized the current papacy.

The entire episode demonstrates how Catholicism's place

SEE VANCE ON A20

BY HANNAH KNOWLES

Kathy McConnell vented about inflation last fall as she waited in line to attend one of Donald Trump's final rallies in Pennsylvania. Grocery store prices were ridiculous, she said, and she hoped Trump would fix things.

Now Trump's tariffs threaten to raise prices again. The stock market rebounded somewhat this week on the news that Trump would pause many levies for 90 days, but it's been a wild ride: McConnell watched her invested pension money drop by 8 percent at one point and wondered if she might have to delay retirement.

She wasn't upset.

"If this is what it takes to make other countries treat us fair," the 64-year-old said, "then I am okay with that."

Trump's roller-coaster tariff policy poses one of the starkest tests yet of his ability to defy political gravity, dividing his allies but also showcasing the remarkable faith of his die-hard base. The politician who campaigned on lowering prices spent the past week asking Americans to accept serious economic pain in the hope of reordering global

SEE TARIFFS ON A16

Japan: Economic anxiety palpable in nation driven by automakers. A8

Rising prices: Retail analysts offer insight on what to buy now. A15

IN THE NEWS

Migrant children The FBI and other federal law enforcement agencies have been enlisted to conduct welfare checks. Advocates worry it's a scheme to deport or scare them. A6

Alex the great Hundreds of Capitals fans braved the rain to honor Alex Ovechkin, the NHL's new all-time top goal scorer. B1

THE NATION Five law firms targeted by Trump have agreed to perform \$600 million in legal services. A2
The White House is targeting Maine funding because it won't ban transgender athletes. A6

THE WORLD High-level talks to rein in Iran's nuclear program are set to begin today in Oman. A7
The head of a U.S. Space Force base in Greenland has been ousted. A9

THE ECONOMY The tariff whiplash is rattling a business in the South Pacific that is developing ethical fair-trade hair accessories for Whole Foods. A13
Consumer sentiment has fallen as Americans anticipate tariff-induced inflation, a widely followed survey found. A14

THE REGION D.C. police say a man shot and killed a woman in front of their children in a Congress Heights apartment building. B1
Dozens of people affected by overseas terrorism have filed a federal lawsuit in Virginia against Iran and North Korea. B1

STYLE Revived plans for a patriotic statutory garden call for the use of funds from federal arts and humanities agencies. C1

SPORTS At the Masters, two-time runner-up Justin Rose was atop a star-packed leader board entering the third round. D1

BUSINESS NEWS.....	A13
COMICS.....	C5
OBITUARIES.....	B4
OPINION PAGES.....	A17
TELEVISION.....	C4
WORLD NEWS.....	A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54184

